



Meeting Pack

NCD Small Craft Registration Board Meeting No.1

2025



NCD SCRB Meeting No.1, 2025
9.00am

Agenda

1. Call to Order

- Chairperson to open the meeting

2. Attendance

2.1 Present

2.2 Apologies

2.3 Absent

3. Disclosure of Conflict of Interest

4. Confirmation of Previous Records

4.1 Minutes of Previous Meeting (if applicable)

4.2 Ratification of any Circular Resolutions

5. Matters Arising from Previous Meetings

6. Correspondence

6.1 Correspondence from the Water Police – *Draft MOU between the RPNGC Water Police Directorate and NCD SCRB* (for discussion and approval)

7. Business of the Meeting

7.1 Registrar's Report – Hitolo Garia, Registrar

- Overview of operational updates, challenges, and 2026 readiness
- Discussion on MOU partnership framework with NCDC–MKA and Water Police

7.2 Financial & Budget Reports

- Review of *2025 Financial Report* (as at 9 October 2025)
- Endorsement of *2025 Budget Summary*
- Approval of the Draft 2026 Budget Forecast (including Operational, Programme, and Remuneration Budgets)
- Discussion on Remuneration Budget (Direct Costs, On-Costs, Summary)

7.3 NCD SCRB Regulation

- Overview and discussion on proposed supplementary provisions to complement the *Small Craft Act 2011* (see separate document attached for Board review).

7.4 Calendar of Events / Work Plan (2025–2026)

- Key awareness, registration, and enforcement programs

8. Other Business

- Items raised by Board Members

9. Closure

10. Date of Next Meeting

- To be confirmed

MEMORANDUM OF UNDERSTANDING

Between

NATIONAL CAPITAL DISTRICT SMALL CRAFT BOARD

and

ROYAL PAPUA NEW GUINEA CONSTABULARY – WATER POLICE DIRECTORATE

FOR

JOINT COOPERATION ON SMALL CRAFT REGISTRATION, LICENSING AND ENFORCEMENT
OPERATIONS

2025

1.0 PREAMBLE

This **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** is made this day of 2025,

Between:

The National Capital District Small Craft Board (hereafter referred to as *the Board*), being the statutory authority established under the Small Craft Act 2011, responsible for the registration, licensing, and regulation of small craft operating within the waters of the National Capital District (NCD);

And

The Royal Papua New Guinea Constabulary (RPNGC) – Water Police Directorate (hereafter referred to as *the Water Police*), headquartered at Konedobu, Port Moresby, responsible for enforcing national laws and maintaining public safety and order within Papua New Guinea’s inland and coastal waters.

Both Parties are hereinafter referred to collectively as “*the Parties*.”

2.0 PURPOSE

The purpose of this MoU is to establish cooperation and coordination between the Water Police and the NCD Small Craft Board for the effective enforcement of the Small Craft Act 2011, particularly regarding:

- Registration and licensing of small craft and operators;
- Joint inspection and compliance patrols;
- Awareness and community engagement programs; and
- Information sharing and reporting of enforcement outcomes.

3.0 OBJECTIVES

The objectives of this MoU are to:

1. Facilitate joint operations to ensure compliance with vessel registration and operator licensing requirements under the Small Craft Act 2011.

2. Enable Water Police officers to conduct inspections and enforcement operations on behalf of, or in conjunction with, authorised inspectors of the Small Craft Board.
3. Establish an agreed arrangement for fuel reimbursement by the Board for enforcement operations conducted within NCD waters.
4. Encourage collaboration on community awareness programs concerning boating safety, registration, and compliance.
5. Ensure consistent reporting of enforcement outcomes including vessels inspected, infringements issued, arrests made, and craft impounded.
6. Strengthen inter-agency cooperation for maritime safety and governance within the National Capital District.

4.0 OBLIGATIONS OF THE PARTIES

4.1 The NCD Small Craft Board undertakes to:

- Coordinate with the Water Police to identify operational priorities and compliance risk areas within NCD waters.
- Provide legislative materials, registration lists, and any other necessary information to support enforcement.
- Reimburse fuel costs used in approved enforcement operations, based on an agreed hourly rate, subject to prior approval where possible.
- Participate in community awareness and education programs alongside the Water Police.
- Maintain and share up-to-date data on registered vessels and licensed operators.

4.2 The Water Police Directorate undertakes to:

- Conduct inspections, compliance patrols, and enforcement operations on behalf of or with authorised inspectors from the Board.
- Ensure all activities are undertaken lawfully under the Small Craft Act and RPNGC operational procedures.
- Provide monthly operational returns to the Board detailing:
 - Number of vessels stopped and inspected;
 - Infringements issued;
 - Arrests made;
 - Craft impounded; and
 - Observations and compliance trends.
- Support community awareness and engagement activities where operationally feasible.
- Maintain the highest professional, ethical, and safety standards during all enforcement and public interactions.

5.0 FINANCIAL ARRANGEMENTS

- Fuel reimbursement will be calculated at an agreed hourly rate according to vessel type and operational duration.
- Prior approval for fuel expenditure will be obtained from the Board where practical.
- Reimbursement claims will be accompanied by operational returns and a summary of hours and fuel used.

6.0 INFORMATION SHARING AND CONFIDENTIALITY

- The Parties will exchange relevant data, intelligence, and enforcement statistics for operational and reporting purposes.
- All shared information will be treated as confidential and used strictly for official purposes.
- Any media release or public statement relating to joint operations will be jointly approved by both Parties before publication.

7.0 COMMUNITY AWARENESS AND EDUCATION

- The Parties agree to cooperate in awareness campaigns and community engagement programs focused on small craft registration, safety, and operator licensing.
- Participation by the Water Police will depend on operational availability and resources.

8.0 LEGAL STATUS AND LIABILITY

- This MoU does not create a legal partnership or agency relationship.
- Personnel from each Party remain employees of their respective organisations.
- Each Party will be responsible for the acts and omissions of its own officers, employees, and agents.

9.0 COORDINATION, MEETINGS AND REPORTING

- Coordination meetings shall be held bi-annually or as required to review operational performance, reporting, and financial arrangements.
- A review of the MoU will be conducted after six months of implementation to assess effectiveness and recommend improvements.

10.0 DURATION, VARIATION AND TERMINATION

- This MoU takes effect from the date of signature and will remain in force for a period of four (4) years, unless earlier terminated by either Party.
- Either Party may terminate this MoU by giving 60 days' written notice to the other.

- The MoU may be amended or varied by mutual written consent of both Parties.

11.0 POINTS OF CONTACT

For the Royal Papua New Guinea Constabulary – Water Police Directorate:

Director, Water Police Directorate
RPNGC Headquarters, Konedobu, Port Moresby
Tel: Email:

For the NCD Small Craft Board:

Hitolo Garia

Registrar, NCD, Small Crafts
Department of Transport Compound, Port Moresby
Tel: (+675) 8239 4576 Email: registrar@ncdsmallcraft.com

12.0 SIGNATORIES

IN WITNESS WHEREOF, the undersigned hereby agree to the terms and conditions set forth in this Memorandum of Understanding.

**For and on behalf of the
Royal Papua New Guinea Constabulary – Water Police Directorate**

.....
David Manning, MBE, OStJ, DPS, QPM
Commissioner of Police
Date:

**For and on behalf of the
National Capital District Small Craft Board**

.....
Chairman
NCD Small Craft Board
Date:

Presented by:

Hitolo Garia

Registrar | NCD Small Crafts Registration Board



REGISTRAR'S REPORT

Submitted to Board for Board Meeting No.1 of 2025

OCTOBER 13, 2025

NCD SMALL CRAFTS REGISTRATION BOARD

Level 1 City Hall Annex Building, Waigani



NCD SMALL CRAFT REGISTRATION BOARD

ADMINISTRATION OFFICE | LEVEL 1 | CITY HALL
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DISTRICT.

P O BOX 1392, PORT MORESBY, NATIONAL CAPITAL DISTRICT

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- Annex A – Financial Report 2025 (as at 9 October 2025)
- Annex B – 2025 Budget Summary
- Annex C – 2026 Budget Forecast
- Annex D – Staffing & Remuneration Costings (Direct Costs, On-Costs, Summary)



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1. Executive Summary

This report provides an operational update on the activities, challenges, and recent developments of the NCD Small Craft Registration Board (NCD SCRB). It highlights progress in registration, enforcement of the *Small Craft Act 2011*, and coordination with enforcement partners. It also identifies key institutional challenges—funding, staffing, and governance and proposes strategies to strengthen small craft safety and compliance across NCD waters.

2. Overview

The NCD Small Craft Registration Board (NCD SCRB) acknowledges the leadership of both the former and current Boards, and the continued support from the National Capital District Commission (NCDC) and the Motu Koita Assembly (MKA).

The first-term Board (May 2020–May 2023), chaired by Mr. Ryan Pini, laid the foundation for implementing the *Small Craft Act 2011* in NCD. However, between 2022 and early 2023, progress slowed due to quorum challenges and members' limited availability. This affected decisions on policy, inspection frameworks, and establishing a permanent office at the waterfront.

After the first Board's term expired, Mr. Pini continued to act in leadership capacity to maintain operations, while the Registrar continued field coordination and registration.

The January 10, 2024 "Black Thursday" looting incident created instability that spilled into maritime operations. Opportunists used small crafts for piracy and armed robbery at Port Moresby's anchorage. PNG Ports Corporation, together with the Water Police, enforced port and maritime security laws to restore confidence and safety. This effort realigned focus on enforcing the *Small Craft Act*, placing pressure on compliance among local operators.

With limited policy and funding capacity, Acting Chair Mr. Pini authorized Theodist Limited in September 2024 to print 600 registration stickers on credit, allowing the rollout of free registration in October 2024. The cost (K30,000) was settled after NCDC released delayed funds in December 2024.

Through 2024–2025, the Registrar continued engagement with PNG Ports, NMSA, and TSSP, and participated in Port Safety & Security Stakeholder Workshops in July 2024 and June 2025. These engagements helped strengthen multi-agency collaboration across the maritime enforcement network.

The second-term Board was sworn in June 2025. Before formal correspondence was issued, **NMSA Legal Division provided written email confirmation authorizing the Board to commence meetings** under Section 3 and 4 of the *Small Craft Act 2011*.

Board Composition (2025–2028):



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- Mr. Ryan Pini – Chair (Private Sector)
- Mr. Nicholas Constantino – Member (Private Sector)
- Mr. Udu Vai – Member (NCDC Representative)
- Mr. Mari Kila – Member (MKA Representative)
- Mr. Neil Papenfus – Member (PNG Ports, Statutory Representative)
- Ms. Megan Taureka Andrew – Member (Private Sector)
- Mr. Aaron Batts – Member (Royal Papua Yacht Club Representative)
- Mr. Paul Gaudi – Member (Motu Koita Community Representative)
- Mr. Nou Vada – Member (Proxy to Mr. Mari Kila; Legal Counsel, Nova Lawyers)

3. Current Issues

3.1 Enforcement and Compliance Pressure

The Water Police's enforcement drive under the *Small Craft Act* has improved compliance but created friction with subsistence fishermen, many of whom depend on dinghies for livelihood.

3.2 Reports of Rogue Conduct

Reports from Motu Koita communities describe instances of:

- Confiscation of fishing catches and equipment
- Spot fines exceeding K500 without receipts
- Intimidation during patrols

The Registrar raised these issues with the Water Police to ensure enforcement is lawful, fair, and sensitive to community livelihoods.

3.3 Private Sector Engagement – RPYC Awareness Session

The **Royal Papua Yacht Club (RPYC)** hosted a Small Craft Awareness Session facilitated by NCD Small Craft Registration Board, and NMSA Legal Team and the Small Craft Officer on **14 October 2025**. The awareness was mainly attended by Small Crafts (Boat/Dinghy) Owners/Operators and members of RPYC.

Key matters raised included:

- Jet ski registration and licensing;
- Recognition of Queensland Marine Licenses;
- Skipper certification and commercial vessel classification; and
- RPYC registration arrangements before 31 December 2025.



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The Registrar advised that these matters will be tabled for Board deliberation, with policy guidance to follow before year-end.

3.4 Operational Limitations

The lack of a patrol boat and waterfront base limits the Registry's ability to conduct inspections and verify enforcement activities. Collaboration with the Water Police for joint patrols is now progressing under an **MOU framework** to be finalized before year-end.

4. Key Challenges

- **Governance:** Quorum challenges between 2022–2023 delayed major policy and program decisions. The Board must ensure regular meetings and consider **appointing proxies** for members frequently unavailable.
- **Funding:** Inconsistent NCDC releases between 2022–2024 constrained operations.
- **Office Space:** The **Koki Fish Market** remains the preferred operational base; Board support is sought to formally engage NCDC and Hon. Justin Tkatchenko (MP).
- **Mobility:** Lack of patrol vessel; partnership with Water Police to provide interim logistics.
- **Policy:** Absence of an approved **Infringement/Penalty/Charges/Fines Policy** remains a critical gap.

5. Way Forward

5.1 Community-Based Inspection Mechanism (Concept Proposal)

The Board will pursue a **combined Small Craft Act Awareness and Inspector Training Workshop**, tentatively scheduled for **2 – 5 December 2025** at the Crowne Plaza Hotel.

Before the workshop, each MKA Councillor will **identify two to three (2–3) community representatives** from their respective wards or electorates, guided by a **selection criteria** to be jointly developed and issued by NCD SCRB and NMSA. These pre-selected representatives will attend the workshop alongside the Councillors, ensuring joint learning on policy awareness, vessel inspection, and basic compliance requirements.

This concept remains **in its proposal stage** and is aimed at establishing a grass-roots inspection and compliance model within MKA communities. While the Registrar has proposed that allowances or logistical support for inspectors could be considered through MKA's internal structures, **this remains a suggestion only** and will be subject to further deliberation and approval by the MKA leadership.

Once refined and endorsed, the initiative will proceed with NMSA's support to formally assess and certify the inspectors before they assume any inspection duties.



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Process: Inspection → Certificate of Compliance → Registration Approval

5.2 MOU: NCDC–MKA Institutional Partnership

A proposed MOU between NCDC and MKA seeks to institutionalize shared oversight, resource allocation, and accountability under the *Small Craft Act 2011*. The objective is to align government policy with community implementation and reinforce collaboration across all stakeholders.

5.3 Joint Patrol Collaboration (Meeting Outcomes and Way Forward)

On **Friday, 10 October 2025**, myself (Registrar) and Chairman **Ryan** met with **Mr. Glenn Finnis**, Executive Director of the **RPNGC Water Police Directorate**, and **Mr. Giwi Yaku**, Assistant Director Operations.

Discussions focused on:

- Development of a **Working Memorandum of Understanding (MOU)** between the Water Police Directorate and the NCD Small Craft Registry;
- **Current registration issues** (new, renewals, and transfers) and coordination challenges at the provincial level; and
- **Opportunities** to streamline information-sharing and conduct joint enforcement operations.

The Registrar also raised ongoing concerns about the **mistreatment of fishermen** by some officers. The Water Police leadership acknowledged these matters and committed to addressing discipline and oversight.

Mr. Finnis confirmed that the **draft MOU** is being prepared and will be shared for review. Once finalized, it will serve as the foundation for **joint patrols, enforcement logistics, and data coordination** between both institutions.

6. Financials

The financial position as of **9 October 2025** remains stable. The 2025 operational grant was released in April.

Annex A: Financial Report 2025 provides details of receipts and expenditures to date.

A **balance of K309,000** remains, earmarked for:

1. Combined SCA Awareness & Inspector Training Workshop
2. Procurement of Patrol Boat (for deliberation)
3. Operator ID Card Machine (PVC type)



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4. Mobile Registration App Development
5. Office furniture and computers

2026 Budget Forecast

Divided into three parts:

- **Part 1 – Operations Budget:** Administrative and logistical operations, including waterfront office setup.
- **Part 2 – Programmes Budget:** Awareness drives, inspector certification, digital upgrades.
- **Part 3 – Structure / Remuneration Budget:** Staffing and payroll framework for 2026–2028.

Supporting Annexes:

- Annex B – 2025 Budget Summary
- Annex C – 2026 Budget Forecast
- Annex D – Remuneration Costings (Direct, On-Costs, Summary)

7. Staffing & Structure (2026 Readiness and Continuity)

Since its establishment in 2020, the NCD Small Craft Registration Board (NCD SCRB) has operated under the Motu Koita Assembly (MKA) payroll structure. Currently, the Registry is managed by the Registrar, who oversees all administrative, operational, and enforcement coordination functions, supported by Admin Support Officer Mr. Andy Frank.

The Registry continues to engage Inspectors on an as-needed basis, primarily during awareness and registration drives. While this arrangement has enabled the program to stay functional, it remains unsustainable without permanent funding and formal staffing provisions.

The MKA's new organizational structure has already been submitted to the Department of Personnel Management (DPM) for Salaries and Conditions Monitoring Committee (SCMC) approval. Once endorsed, the current MKA structure—and by extension, the Registrar and Admin Support Officer's positions—will cease to exist under MKA's payroll. This could occur before the end of 2025 or early 2026, presenting a serious continuity risk for the Registry's operations.



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7.1 Immediate Priority — NCDC Funding for Continuity

The Board must urgently secure **direct and increased NCDC funding** in the 2026 fiscal year to safeguard continuity and transition the Registry into a fully functional office with adequate support.

7.2 Medium-Term Institutionalisation via SCMC

Once the NCDC provides interim funding and the Registry stabilises, the Board can then pursue SCMC endorsement to formalise the structure under NCDC's administrative system, ensuring long-term job security, salary grading, and proper reporting lines.

7.3 Decisions Sought

1. Approve the 2025 and 2026 budget
2. Endorse the preparation of a formal funding submission to NCDC for staffing and office establishment/Operations;

Summary:

The NCD Small Craft Registry currently operates on minimal manpower and temporary support. Securing NCDC funding in 2026 is critical to maintaining operations, protecting existing staff, and transitioning the Registry from an ad-hoc setup to a professional, permanent maritime institution.

9. Conclusion

The NCD Small Craft Registration Board has shown exceptional resilience through years of financial and institutional uncertainty. The establishment of the second-term Board has restored stability and momentum, paving the way for sustained progress under the renewed leadership of **Chairman Mr. Ryan Pini**.

With the Registrar and Admin Support Officer carrying the full administrative and operational load - and Inspectors engaged only when funding permits—the Registry's current model is stretched but still performing. This dedication has kept NCD's small-craft safety framework functioning despite limited resources.

Looking ahead, 2026 will be a decisive year. The Board's priorities must now focus on:

- **Securing full NCDC funding** to support staffing and office establishment;
- **Establishing a permanent base** at the Koki Fish Market to improve service access;
- Finalising the **Penalties/Fines Policy** for consistent, fair enforcement;
- Implementing the **NCDC-MKA-SCRB MOU** to institutionalise coordination and accountability (for deliberation); and



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- Advancing the **Community-Based Inspection & Awareness Program**, empowering MKA councillors and local inspectors to lead compliance at the grassroots level.

Through the continued partnership of **NCDC, MKA, NMSA, PNG Ports, and the Water Police**, the SCRB is poised to evolve from a small administrative office into a fully recognised maritime regulator for the National Capital District.

With proper support and clear direction, 2026 will mark the year that the NCD Small Craft Registration Board transforms from a transitional setup into a **strong, sustainable, and community-driven maritime institution** dedicated to safety, compliance, and the well-being of NCD's coastal communities.

Hitolo Garia

Registrar | NCD Small Craft Registration Board

NCD SMALL CRAFTS REGISTRATION BOARD
PROPOSED REMUNERATION BUDGET - DIRECT COSTS

No.	Position	Pay Band	Contract Type	Base Salary	Housing Allowance	MV Fuel Allowance	Contract Allowance	Domestic Market Allowance (DMA)	Gratuity (25% of Base Salary)	Total
1	Registrar	MK14	C2	72,943	12,500	7,500	10,500	10,000	18,236	131,679
2	Administration & Finance Officer	MK12	C4	60,843	10,000	-	5,501	-	15,211	91,555
3	Compliance and Enforcement Officer	MK12	C4	60,843	10,000	-	5,501	-	15,211	91,555
4	Community Liason Officer	MK10	C5	52,066	6,200	-	-	-	-	58,266
5	Coordinator - Search & Rescue	MK10	C5	52,066	6,200	-	-	-	-	58,266
6	Admin Support Officer	MK05	NC	33,735	-	-	3,374	-	-	37,109
7	Data Entry Officer	MK05	NC	33,735	-	-	3,374	-	-	37,109
8	Inspector	MK04	NC	31,668	-	-	3,167	-	-	34,835
9	Inspector	MK04	NC	31,668	-	-	3,167	-	-	34,835
10	Inspector	MK04	NC	31,668	-	-	3,167	-	-	34,835
11	Inspector	MK04	NC	31,668	-	-	3,167	-	-	34,835
12	Inspector	MK04	NC	31,668	-	-	3,167	-	-	34,835
12				524,571	44,900	7,500	44,083	10,000	48,657	679,711

NCD SMALL CRAFTS REGISTRATION BOARD
PROPOSED REMUNERATION BUDGET - PAYROLL ONCOSTS

No.	Position	Pay Band	Contract Type	Base Salary	Super (8.4%)	Annual Leave	Long Service Leave	Total
1	Registrar	MK14	C2	72,943	6,127	4,208	2,431	12,767
2	Administration & Finance Officer	MK12	C4	60,843	5,111	3,510	2,028	10,649
3	Compliance and Enforcement Officer	MK12	C4	60,843	5,111	3,510	2,028	10,649
4	Community Liason Officer	MK10	C5	52,066	4,374	3,004	1,736	9,113
5	Coordinator - Search & Rescue	MK10	C5	52,066	4,374	3,004	1,736	9,113
6	Admin Support Officer	MK05	NC	33,735	2,834	1,946	1,124	5,904
7	Data Entry Officer	MK05	NC	33,735	2,834	1,946	1,124	5,904
8	Inspector	MK04	NC	31,668	2,660	1,827	1,056	5,543
9	Inspector	MK04	NC	31,668	2,660	1,827	1,056	5,543
10	Inspector	MK04	NC	31,668	2,660	1,827	1,056	5,543
11	Inspector	MK04	NC	31,668	2,660	1,827	1,056	5,543
12	Inspector	MK04	NC	31,668	2,660	1,827	1,056	5,543
12				524,571	44,064	30,264	17,486	91,813

NCD SMALL CRAFTS REGISTRATION BOARD
PROPOSED REMUNERATION BUDGET SUMMARY

No.	Position	Pay Band	Contract Type	Total Direct Costs	Total Oncosts	Total Remuneration
1	Registrar	MK14	C2	131,679	12,767	144,446
2	Administration & Finance Officer	MK12	C4	91,555	10,649	102,204
3	Compliance and Enforcement Officer	MK12	C4	91,555	10,649	102,204
4	Community Liason Officer	MK10	C5	58,266	9,113	67,379
5	Coordinator - Search & Rescue	MK10	C5	58,266	9,113	67,379
6	Admin Support Officer	MK05	NC	37,109	5,904	43,013
7	Data Entry Officer	MK05	NC	37,109	5,904	43,013
8	Inspector	MK04	NC	34,835	5,543	40,378
9	Inspector	MK04	NC	34,835	5,543	40,378
10	Inspector	MK04	NC	34,835	5,543	40,378
11	Inspector	MK04	NC	34,835	5,543	40,378
12	Inspector	MK04	NC	34,835	5,543	40,378
12				679,711	91,813	771,524

FINANCIAL REPORT

NCD SMALL CRAFT REGISTRATION BOARD

FOR THE PERIOD 1 JAN 2025 TO 9 OCT 2025

		1 JAN 2023	4 DEC 2024	YTD
	31 DEC 2023	- 31 DEC 2024	- 31 DEC 2024	1 JAN 2025
	Closing Bal			- 9 Oct 2025
	52,033.71	52,033.71	825.63	149,641.63
INCOME				
	Opening Bal	52,033.71	825.63	149,641.63
270 - GRANTS (NCDC GRANT ALLOCATION)	-		200,000.00	200,000.00
280 - INCOME FROM REGISTRATIONS & LICENSES/PERMITS	-	2,100.00	700.00	3,550.00
GROSS	-	54,133.71	201,525.63	353,191.63
OPERATING EXPENSES				
404 BANK FEES/CHARGES		117.00	12.50	89.50
431 SCAIP - Continuation Phase (Awareness, Registration & Licensing Rollout)		15,437.00	-	1,350.00
409 Office - Stationeries/Consumables/Furnitures		8,557.83	5,407.10	8,242.40
430 Registration Stickers		5,121.60	30,144.40	12,838.10
429 Registration Application Software		-	-	-
411 Memberships/Subscriptions		2,763.00		4,050.00
410 Wages		9,200.00	800.00	7,200.00
449 MV Expenses (Repair & Maintenance/Fuel/Accessories/Rego etc)		9,228.85	1,400.00	3,586.00
420 Communications (Internet, Data Recharges/Top ups)		1,400.00	200.00	200.00
480 Media Advertising - RADIO (Small Craft Safety at Sea - Awareness Drive)		-	13,920.00	-
453 General Admin Expenses		1,482.80	-	6,481.45
TOTAL OPERATING EXPENSES		53,308.08	51,884.00	44,037.45
NET	-	825.63	149,641.63	309,154.18



NCD SMALL CRAFT REGISTRATION BOARD

2025 BUDGET

PART 1 - OPERATIONAL BUDGET

OFFICE RENTAL	-
MV EXPENSES (Fuel/Service/Repair/Registration etc...)	12,000.00
ADMINISTRATIVE EXPENSES	25,000.00
STATIONERIES/CONSUMABLES/EQUIPMENTS/FURNITURES	22,000.00
PROCUREMENT OF NEW PATROL BOAT	45,000.00
FUEL SUPPORT JOINT ENFORCEMENT PARTNERSHIP WIT WP	25,000.00
BOAT BERTHING DUES (RPYC)	-
	129,000.00

PART 2 - PROGRAMME BUDGET

1. AWARENESS & EDUCATION

SCA Awareness - Community & Stakeholder Engagement Workshop	60,000.00
Inspectors Training Workshop Facilitation	60,000.00
Radio/Newspaper/TV (Media)	-
Village Awareness programs	-

2. REGISTRATIONS

Registration Stickers Printing	15,000.00
Registration Application Development	45,000.00
	-

TOTAL	
	180,000.00

TOTAL	309,000.00
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NCD SMALL CRAFT REGISTRATION BOARD

2026 BUDGET FORECAST

PART 1 - OPERATIONAL BUDGET

OFFICE RENTAL (Estimated at 10K Below Budget Office space)	120,000.00
MV EXPENSES	30,000.00
ADMINISTRATIVE EXPENSES	80,000.00
OFFICE SET UP (STATIONERIES/CONSUMABLES/EQUIPMENTS/FURNITURES ETC)	100,000.00
FUEL (For Patrol Boat) Or Joint Patrol Partnership	60,000.00
BOAT BERTHING DUES (RPYC)	35,000.00
	425,000.00

PART 2 - PROGRAMME BUDGET

1. AWARENESS & EDUCATION

SCA AwarenessCommunity &Stakeholder Engagement Workshop	-
Radio/Newspaper/TV (Media)	80,000.00
Village Awareness programs	45,000.00

2. REGISTRATIONS

Registration Stickers Printing	45,000.00
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TOTAL	170,000.00
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PART 3 - STRUCTURE/REMUNERATION BUDGET

1. Staffing & Remuneration Costs (Full Details on Annex A, B, C)

Direct Costs	679,711.00
On-Costs	91,813.00

TOTAL	771,524.00
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TOTAL	1,366,524.00
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NCD Small Craft Registration Board (NCD SCRB)

Summary – Proposed Supplementary Provisions to the Small Craft Act 2011

(Working Draft for Board Discussion – 28 October 2025)

1. Background

The **Small Craft Act 2011** provides the legal foundation for the registration, licensing, and operation of small crafts across Papua New Guinea’s maritime provinces. Under this framework, each province is mandated to establish its own Small Craft Registration Board (SCRB), Registrar, and Inspectors to administer the Act.

The **NCD Small Craft Registration Board (NCD SCRB)**, established under the National Capital District Commission (NCDC), operates within a unique metropolitan and coastal environment that differs significantly from traditional maritime provinces. As a result, the practical implementation of the Act in NCD requires additional administrative, operational, and enforcement provisions tailored to the district’s urban, commercial, and enforcement realities.

The proposed supplementary provisions—referred to as the **NCD Small Craft (Administrative Provisions) Regulation**—are intended to complement the *Small Craft Act 2011* and provide clarity, structure, and continuity to the work of the NCD SCRB.

2. Rationale for the Additions

The rationale for developing a supplementary regulation is grounded in the following: -

- **Administrative Gaps:** The Act establishes the framework but does not set out provincial or district-level administrative processes, particularly for coordination between NCDC, MKA, and enforcement agencies.
- **Operational Context:** NCD’s environment involves dense traffic, mixed-use coastal operations (fishing, transport, recreation), and complex enforcement across multiple authorities (Water Police, PNG Ports, NMSA, etc.).
- **Accountability and Governance:** To define clear lines of authority between the Board, Registrar, and Inspectors, ensuring transparency and compliance with both NMSA and NCDC oversight.
- **Digital Transformation:** To formalize the use of digital registration, inspection, and data systems currently being piloted under the NCD SCRB app.

- **Sustainability and Funding:** To institutionalize budget management, fee collection, and remuneration under a regulated framework, ensuring continuity and accountability.
- **Community Integration:** To align implementation with Motu Koita Assembly (MKA) structures and local community inspectors to enhance safety awareness and compliance at the grassroots level.

3. Scope of the Supplementary Regulation

The supplementary regulation will **not replace** or **amend** the Small Craft Act 2011. Instead, it will serve as a **supporting instrument** for NCD SCRB operations, focusing on the following key areas:

a. Administrative Provisions

- Board structure, quorum, and tenure of members.
- Delegation of authority to Registrar and Inspectors.
- Meeting procedures, circular resolutions, and record-keeping requirements.

b. Operational Procedures

- Standardized processes for registration, renewal, transfer, and replacement of certificates.
- Use of digital systems for record management, inspection, and vessel verification.
- Clear procedures for inspections, vessel compliance, and issuance of load line markings.

c. Compliance and Enforcement

- Establishment of a **Penalty Points System** and **Default Fine Schedule** tailored to NCD operations, consistent with national standards.
- Clarification of inspector powers and obligations under the law.
- Integration of joint patrol and enforcement mechanisms through the **MOU with the Water Police**.

d. Financial Management

- Governance around the collection, retention, and disbursement of registration and licensing fees.
- Annual budget preparation, financial reporting, and auditing requirements.
- Clarity on use of funds for community awareness, training, and enforcement.

e. Staffing and Remuneration

- Definition of core Registry positions and associated pay bands (aligned with the 2026 Remuneration Budget).
- Procedures for appointment, performance review, and termination.
- Alignment with **NCDC** and **SCMC** standards to ensure sustainability and accountability.

f. Community Engagement and Awareness

- Institutionalizing awareness and education initiatives on safety at sea.
 - Defining the structure for community-based inspectors and collaboration with Motu Koita Assembly ward representatives.
 - Encouraging partnerships with private sector stakeholders (e.g., RPYC, PNG Ports, and local operators).
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4. Expected Benefits

- **Improved Governance:** Clear structure for decision-making, accountability, and reporting.
 - **Operational Efficiency:** Streamlined registration, inspection, and compliance processes through digital systems.
 - **Enhanced Safety:** Strengthened enforcement and awareness leading to safer waterways.
 - **Sustainability:** A formal structure for budgeting, staffing, and long-term continuity.
 - **Partnerships:** Strengthened collaboration between NCDC, MKA, NMSA, and the Water Police through formal agreements.
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5. Next Steps

1. Board endorsement to proceed with the **drafting of the supplementary regulation**.
 2. Engagement with **legal counsel** (Nova Lawyers / NMSA Legal Division) to review scope and ensure consistency with the *Small Craft Act 2011*.
 3. Consultation with **stakeholders** (NCDC, MKA, Water Police, NMSA) for input before formal submission.
 4. Presentation of a final draft to the Board for approval prior to submission to NMSA for review and endorsement.
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6. Governance and Endorsement Framework

Governance Note: Authority, Delegation, and Endorsement

Authority under the Small Craft Act 2011

The *Small Craft Act 2011* is national legislation enacted by the National Parliament of Papua New Guinea to regulate the registration, licensing, and safety of small craft throughout the country.

Under *Part II – Provincial Administration*, the Act authorizes each Provincial Executive Council (PEC), or in the case of the National Capital District, the NCD Provincial Executive Council, to establish a Small Craft Registration Board (SCRB) responsible for administering and enforcing the Act within its jurisdiction.

Delegation and Oversight

The National Maritime Safety Authority (NMSA) is designated under the Act as the national body responsible for policy direction, technical regulation, and coordination of provincial small craft activities.

Accordingly:

- The NCD SCRB operates under delegation from and in coordination with the NMSA.
- The NMSA retains authority to issue policy, procedural, and technical directions binding on all provincial and district boards, including the NCD SCRB.

Scope of Local Authority

The NCD SCRB may:

- Develop and implement administrative rules, operational procedures, and local regulations necessary to give effect to the Act within the NCD;
- Propose supplementary rules or amendments to improve local implementation, provided these do not conflict with the Act or NMSA directives;
- Seek endorsement of such supplementary rules by the NMSA before formal adoption by the NCD Provincial Executive Council.

Requirement for NMSA Endorsement

Any rule, amendment, or policy proposal that:

- Affects or interprets provisions of the *Small Craft Act 2011*;
- Introduces new regulatory or enforcement measures;
- Impacts national standards for registration, licensing, inspection, or safety;
Must be submitted to the NMSA for review and endorsement prior to implementation or enforcement.

Final Adoption

Following NMSA endorsement, the NCD Provincial Executive Council (PEC) shall approve, gazette (where necessary), and authorize implementation of the supplementary rules and related instruments within the National Capital District.

Policy Note: Delegation and Endorsement Process

1. The NCD SCRB, through its Chairperson and Registrar, may draft or commission supplementary regulations to strengthen implementation of the *Small Craft Act 2011* within NCD.
2. All draft regulations must first be reviewed by NCD SCRB members for completeness and consistency with existing legislation.

3. The draft shall be shared with **NCDC, MKA, Water Police Directorate, PNG Ports Corporation**, and the **NMSA Legal Division** for comment.
4. The reviewed draft shall be submitted to **NMSA Legal Division** (and, if applicable, external legal counsel) for vetting and conformity with the Act.
5. Upon completion of legal review, the Chairperson shall formally submit the proposed regulation to **NMSA** for written endorsement under the Act.
6. Once endorsed by NMSA, the regulation shall be recorded in the NCD SCRB Register and implemented under the authority of the Board and Registrar, and submitted to **NCDC** for administrative noting and budget alignment.